



DELHI | Running Short of Time

If Rajnath Singh's supporters are to be believed, he needs more time as BJP president to do all the things that he has set out to do. So while the party is busy finalising the agenda for the National Executive meeting in February, the last one before the Lok Sabha elections and working out campaign strategy, election issues and preparing candidates' lists, they want to add to the agenda: a change in the party's constitution to give him another term or at least one more year. His current terms ends in November 2009. Their rationale is that the party will be busy with the Lok Sabha elections leaving little time to go through the detailed procedure to elect a new president. The process requires almost a year to complete. As per the BJP constitution, the president, who enjoys a three-year tenure, is elected by members of the state councils and national councils. It means involvement of district level units and regional committees which comprise the state councils. The process has to begin from the grassroot level of local and mandal committees. In view of this, Singh's supporters are taking the plea that there will not be sufficient time left after the Lok Sabha polls to start and complete the procedure before his term expires. Even if accepted, the demand may amount to nothing since the last four party chiefs have had to quit much before their tenures ended. *by Bhavna Vij-Aurora*

**RAJNATH SINGH
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11

months are left for Rajnath Singh's term as BJP president to end, leading his loyalists to lobby for an extension via a change in the party constitution.